

Linchen Zhang

📞 +1 (858) 319-5383 ✉️ liz032@ucsd.edu 🌐 linchenzhang.github.io

Department of Economics ✧ University of California, San Diego

9500 Gilman Drive, La Jolla, CA 92093

Placement Director: Prashant Bharadwaj

+1 (858) 822-6760

prbharadwaj@ucsd.edu

Placement Coordinator: Andrew Flores

+1 (858) 534-1867

econ-jobmarket@ucsd.edu

EDUCATION

University of California, San Diego

San Diego, CA

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics

Sep 2021 – Jun 2027 (Expected)

Cornell University

Ithaca, NY

B.A. in Computer Science, Economics (Magna Cum Laude), and Mathematics

Aug 2017 – May 2021

FIELDS OF INTEREST

Microeconomic Theory, Behavioral and Experimental Economics

WORKING PAPERS

Recognizing Dominance through Local Improvement (*Job Market Paper*)

- A mechanism is locally improvement solvable if, starting from any strategy, repeatedly replacing it with an improving neighbor strategy leads to a dominant strategy; strategy-proofness is the coarsest member of this family, and the classical mechanisms are solvable under finer relations that give a short path to the dominant strategy.
- Draft coming soon!

Market Order Mechanisms (with [Ben Brooks](#) and [Songzi Du](#))

- If the market order mechanisms satisfy vanishing price impact and vanishing span, they can guarantee competitive outcomes in the large, regardless of information structures and equilibria.

Coarse Revenue Guarantee in First Price Auction and Beyond

- Characterized the worst-case revenue in the first-price auction over all Bayes coarse correlated equilibria.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Conditional Dominance and Rationalizability with Information-Based Continuation Reasoning (with [Joel Watson](#))

- Draft coming soon!

Strategic Obliviousness (with [Emanuel Vespa](#) and [Andreas Ziegler](#))

- Current stage: Collecting third round of data.

PROFESSIONAL / ACADEMIC ACTIVITIES

Academic Presentations

2026: Econometric Society Asian-China Meeting, Southwest Economics Theory Conference, Asian School in Theory, UCLA Student Theory Conference, UCSD TBE Workshop

2025: 36th Stony Brook Game Theory Conference, Caltech Student Theory Conference, UCSD TBE Workshop

2024: EC'24 (poster), 35th Stony Brook Game Theory Conference, GAIMSS'24, UCSD TBE Workshop

Discussions and Service

2026: Program Committee, ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (EC)

2026: Panelist, Virtual Seminars in Economic Theory, on Lea Nagel's talk "Designing Simpler Mechanisms: Transparency and As-If Dominance"

AWARDS / FELLOWSHIPS

Clive Granger Research Fellowship, UC San Diego
awarded for the most promising graduate student research 2025

Summer Research Fellowship, UC San Diego 2022, 2023

Regents Fellowship, UC San Diego 2021

Honorable Mention, Mathematical Contest in Modeling (MCM) 2019

Top 500, William Lowell Putnam Mathematical Competition 2018

Omicron Delta Epsilon (International Economics Honor Society), Cornell University

Dean's List (All semesters), Cornell University 2017 – 2021

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record at UC San Diego

ECON 5: Data Analysis in Social Science *Fall 2024, Fall 2025*

Teaching Assistant at UC San Diego

ECON 1: Principles of Microeconomics *Fall 2022, Fall 2023*

ECON 4: Financial Accounting *Winter 2023, Spring 2024*

ECON 5: Data Analysis in Social Science *Spring 2025*

ECON 100B: Microeconomics B *Winter 2024, Winter 2026*

ECON 149: Market Design *Winter 2024, Winter 2025*

ECON 173B: Corporate Finance *Spring 2023*

SKILLS / OTHER INFO

- **Programming:** Python, STATA, MATLAB, R, $\LaTeX$
- **Languages:** Mandarin Chinese (native), English (proficient)

REFERENCES

Songzi Du (Chair)

Associate Professor

Department of Economics, UC San Diego

sodu@ucsd.edu

Aram Grigoryan

Assistant Teaching Professor

Department of Economics, UC San Diego

a2grigoryan@ucsd.edu

Joel Watson

Professor

Department of Economics, UC San Diego

jwatson@ucsd.edu

Emanuel Vespa

Professor

Department of Economics, UC San Diego

evespa@ucsd.edu